



In 1699, Welsh naturalist and museum keeper Edward Lhyud published the first illustrated catalogue of British fossils.

1694

Secrets of flowers

German botanist Rudolf Camerarius provided scientific proof that flowering plants reproduce sexually. He showed that pollen, a powdery dust produced on the male stamens, is necessary for fertilization of the female germ cells (called ovules). When he removed the stamens, the flowers failed to seed.



Comparing brain sizes



Macaque monkey brain



Chimpanzee brain



Human brain

1699

Chimpanzee study

Edward Tyson was an English physician and anatomist. He dissected the body of a chimpanzee, which he called an orang-outang, or "man of the woods." The creature had been brought to London on a ship from Africa and died shortly afterward. Tyson concluded that its anatomy, particularly its brain, was closer to that of a man than a monkey.



1690

1695

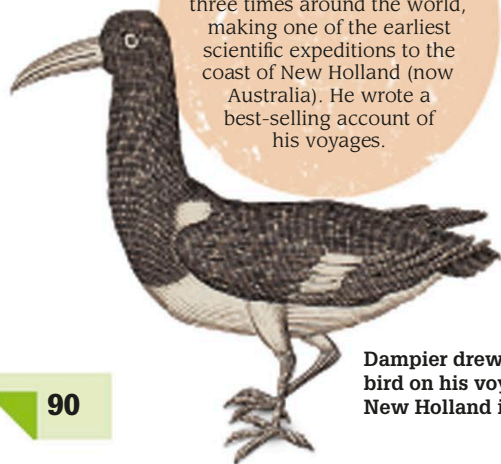
1697

Mistaken theory

Georg Stahl, a German chemist, argued that a substance or "essence" called phlogiston is released into the air whenever something is burned, leaving the calx (or ash). His theory was widely believed until disproved by Antoine Lavoisier (see p.107).

World traveler

William Dampier, an English adventurer, sailed three times around the world, making one of the earliest scientific expeditions to the coast of New Holland (now Australia). He wrote a best-selling account of his voyages.

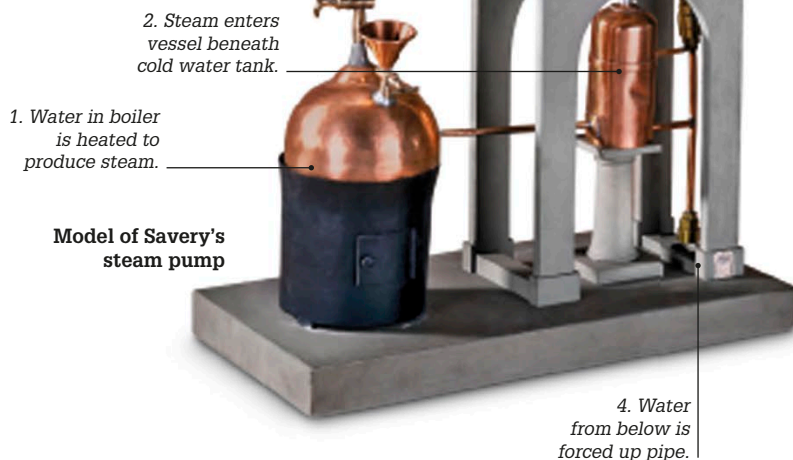


Dampier drew this bird on his voyage to New Holland in 1699.

1698

Steam pump

English inventor Thomas Savery designed a steam pump to extract floodwater from mines. It worked by condensing steam to create a vacuum. As air rushed in to fill it, atmospheric pressure forced up water from the mine. The entire process was controlled by a system of taps.



Model of Savery's steam pump

4. Water from below is forced up pipe.